

TidyTuesday Week 34

Pranay Gundam

Tuesday 18th August, 2026

Contents

1	Weekly Summary	2
2	Date: 2026-08-18	3
2.1	Raw Regression	3
2.2	Detrended Regression	5

1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

This week the machine reached into the great economic tombola and pulled out a truly inspired duo: a discontinued index tracking the real output of American hospitals and nursing homes, and the house price index for Nassau and Suffolk counties on Long Island. Because nothing says "meaningful economic inquiry" like asking whether the fortunes of Long Island real estate can be explained by how many people are checking into New York-adjacent nursing facilities. Naturally, we ran the numbers with the appropriate gravitas.

And oh, the raw regression delivered. An R-squared of about 0.60, a p-value with more zeros after the decimal than I have fingers, coefficients standing tall and statistically proud. For one shining moment it looked like we had cracked it: hospital output and Long Island home values, locked in an eternal cosmic dance. Somebody call an economics journal. Somebody call a realtor. Somebody call whoever discontinued this series in 2016 and tell them what they gave up on.

Then, as always, the detrended version wandered in and turned off the lights. Strip out the fact that both series mostly just drift upward over the years – as basically every economic quantity in a growing economy tends to do – and the whole thing evaporates. R-squared collapses to a limp 0.08, the p-value balloons to a deeply unimpressed 0.23, and the coefficient's confidence interval sprawls comfortably across zero like it's on vacation. In other words: the "relationship" was just two things going up at the same time for entirely unrelated reasons. A textbook trend mirage, and exactly the kind of thing this project exists to point at and laugh.

As always, the standard disclaimer applies with feeling: these are randomly paired series with zero theoretical reason to be connected, and any correlation here is a happy accident of arithmetic, not evidence that hospital beds move mortgage prices. Spurious is the house style. This week the raw regression flexed hard and the detrended version quietly explained that it was all a misunderstanding – which is honestly the most predictable plot twist we've got.

2 Date: 2026-08-18

Series ID: USHSPTLNRSQGSP

This series is titled Quantity Indexes for Real Gross Domestic Product by Industry: Private Industries: Educational Services, Health Care, and Social Assistance: Health Care and Social Assistance: Hospitals and Nursing and Residential Care Facilities for United States (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Index 2009=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1997-01-01 and the observation end date is 2016-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: ATNHPIUS35004Q

This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for Nassau County-Suffolk County, NY (MSAD) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1975-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01. The popularity of this series is 21.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS35004Q	R-squared:	0.595
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.573
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	26.47
Date:	Tue, 18 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	6.80e-05
Time:	12:24:41	Log-Likelihood:	-101.38
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	206.8
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	208.7
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-202.2530	81.976	-2.467	0.024	-374.478	-30.028
value_fred_USHSPTLNRSQGSP	4.5554	0.885	5.145	0.000	2.695	6.416

Omnibus:	3.374	Durbin-Watson:	0.176
Prob(Omnibus):	0.185	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.734
Skew:	0.872	Prob(JB):	0.255
Kurtosis:	2.515	Cond. No.	837.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

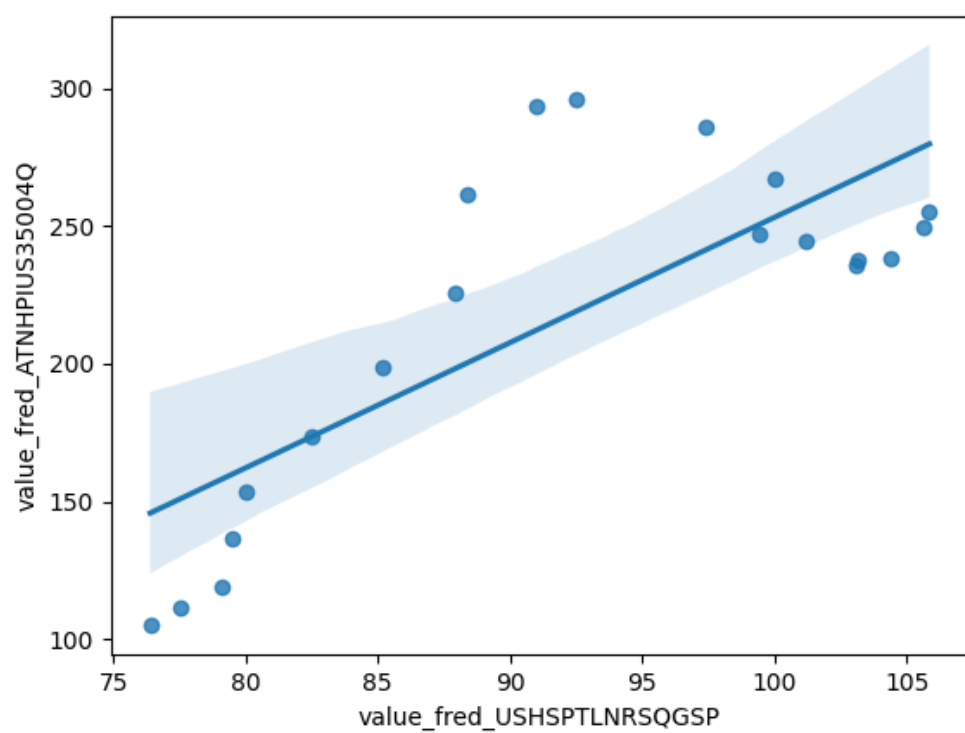


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-18

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS35004Q_detrended	R-squared:	0.079
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.028
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1.551
Date:	Tue, 18 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.229
Time:	12:24:41	Log-Likelihood:	-101.26
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	206.5
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	208.5
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.868e-11	9.015	2.07e-12	1.000	-18.941	18.941
value_fred_USHSPTLNRSQGSP_detrended	7.1907	5.773	1.246	0.229	-4.938	19.320

Omnibus:	3.498	Durbin-Watson:	0.209
Prob(Omnibus):	0.174	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.716
Skew:	0.887	Prob(JB):	0.257
Kurtosis:	2.669	Cond. No.	1.56

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

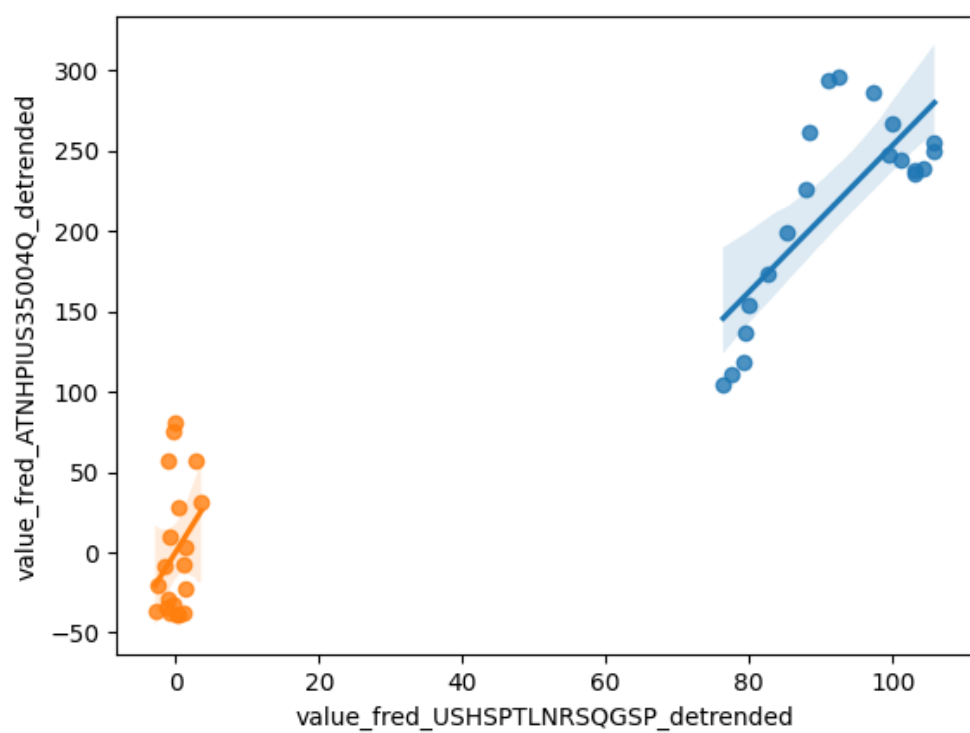


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-18